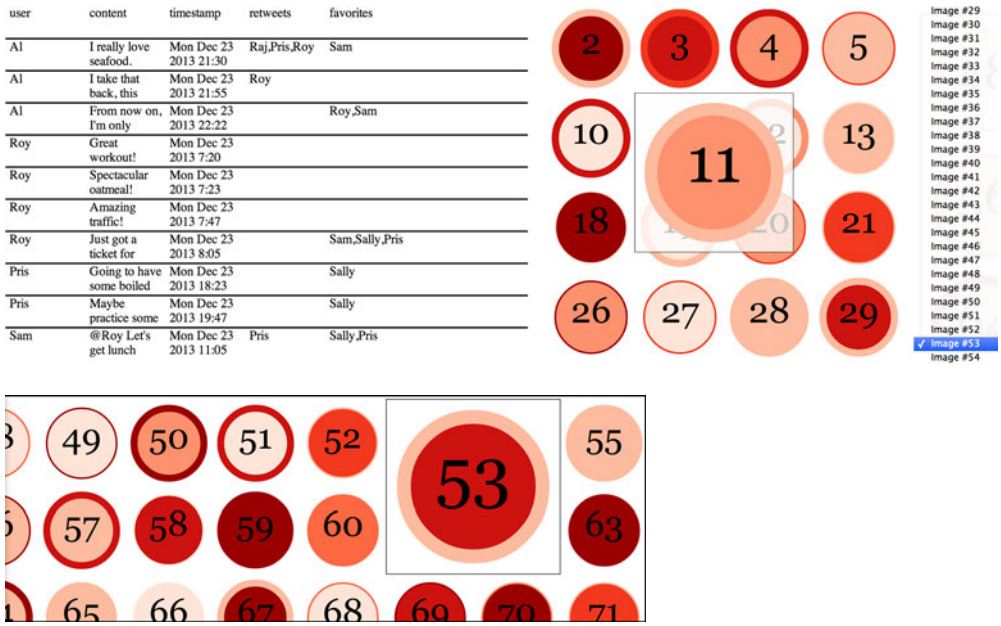


Figure 8.1 The traditional DOM-based pieces that are created in this chapter are a spreadsheet (section 8.2) and an image gallery (section 8.4), with interactivity based on a data-driven drop-down list (section 8.4.2) and images drawn using HTML5 canvas (8.3).

The principles at work in D3 not only *can* be used for traditional DOM elements, but in many cases *should* be used that way. In this chapter, we'll use D3 to create a spreadsheet as well as an image gallery. We'll also explore how to use HTML5 canvas to draw and save images. This won't include an exhaustive example of canvas, because that's beyond the scope of the book, but it'll give you the fundamentals to deploy it in tandem with D3 in your applications. In each case, we'll use D3 data-binding, transitions, and selections the same way we did to make charts, but instead make more traditional HTML elements.

By using the same datasets and functions to deal with your DOM elements as you do with your SVG elements, you make it easier to tie them together and reduce the amount of syntax you need to learn to deploy rich sites. In later chapters, you'll see these different methods of presenting information working in together in tandem.

8.1 Setup

As you may expect, we need to make a few changes to the files we're working with, now that we're going to do coding that resembles more traditional web development. In one case, this means simplifying, because our HTML page loses the `<svg>` element necessary for representing SVG graphics, but in another sense it means making things more complex. Although we used CSS primarily for graphical changes with SVG, we need to use it for more than that when working with traditional DOM elements.